



UNIVERSITY
OF OSLO

Master's thesis

The title of my thesis

Any short subtitle

My Name

Mathematics
60 ECTS study points

Department of Mathematics
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My Name

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Supervisor:
The Name

Abstract

Here come 3–6 sentences describing your thesis.

This is a relatively short working example of the UiO template for a Master's thesis written in L^AT_EX. The example is based on Dag Langemyhr's excellent template compliant with the UiO designmanual from 2022, Martin Helsø's instructive examples (2017–2019) and Karoline Moe's seminars on writing in mathematical subjects (2014–2024). We show how some of the standard and most helpful features can be used efficiently, but please note that several of the chapters, sections, packages, tools and environments are optional to include in your thesis and that you must adapt and modify the template to suit your thesis and the traditions in your field of study. If in doubt, ask! Your supervisor and department have the final say in this.

Sammendrag

Her kommer Abstract på et annet språk. Det skal være et sammendrag på norsk i Ph.d.-avhandlinger. Det er like greit å ha det i en masteroppgave også. Det kan være utfordrende å skrive, men det er nyttig.

Dette er en relativt kort tekst der vi bruker UiOs mal for masteroppgaver...

Add new section about results in Chapter 1.

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Preface

The preface is a short and perhaps more personal description of the project, the purpose and your motivation for pursuing it. It should be short and sweet; and it is different from the acknowledgements.

This template has grown out of the work with seminars about scientificness and writing in mathematical subjects that was organized by the Department of Mathematics and the Science Library at the University of Oslo (UiO), and hosted by Karoline Moe, Ph.D., in the period from 2014 to 2024.

There has always been a tradition at the department that former students pass their $\text{\LaTeX}$ -template on to the next generation of students. However, this practice did not ensure compliance neither with standard traditions in scientific writing and reference management, nor with subsequent design manuals at UiO and typography. Moreover, some of the commands and packages in $\text{\LaTeX}$ used by students were outdated or in conflict, and there was clearly a need for more instruction.

This template tries to answer these issues. The main purpose of the template is to serve as a starting point for all students using $\text{\LaTeX}$ to write their Master's thesis. First of all it is a 'minimal' working example with the structure of a thesis. Secondly, We have included examples that most students frequently run into and that can take forever to figure out, even with all available tools, search engines and AI. Finally, we have tried to include a description or short text of the most essential genre-features or pit-falls for each chapter.

We sincerely hope that this template can be of some help in your work, and feel free to send the the $\text{\LaTeX}$ -group at the University of Oslo Library an e-mail on latexguru@ub.uio.no if you are stuck!

Acknowledgements

The acknowledgements is where you thank everyone who have contributed to the thesis. It is mandatory to thank your supervisor, co-supervisor, your department and other parties that you have cooperated with; fellow students, a company etc.

The acknowledgements is usually written in a more personal tone than other parts of the thesis, and you should use the pronoun ‘I’ when you write. F.ex. I would like to thank Dag Langemyhr and Martin Helsø for their passion for L^AT_EX, their dedication to elegance and detail in typography, and for reading the package documentation at *The Comprehensive TeX Archive Network* (CTAN)¹ so that the rest of us can worry less about layout and more about The Millennium Prize Problems².

In the acknowledgements it is custom to include important events that have happened during the period where you were working on the project. Sometimes, this can be done with humor and creativity. But be extremely cautious! Humor changes over time, your life and perspective changes, and you never know who will read this part of your thesis. What seems funny now might be extremely insulting or embarrassing in a couple of years³.

In fact, the acknowledgements is the part of the thesis that *everyone* who picks up your thesis will read, not just the examiner or the interested researcher. I recommend that you visualize your audience when you feel most creative: your supervisor, your parents, your grandmother, your ex, your future boss, your future co-workers, your future kids, and, perhaps most importantly, your future students.

The fact that your audience might be larger than you think, can not be stressed enough. And this applies to the entire thesis. Your thesis will eventually be deposited in and made openly available to the entire world via the institutional repository DUO. Because of the UiO-address, it gets a high rating on search engines and will be very easy to find for interested researchers all over the world. Moreover, most researchers subscribe to alerts when new citations of their articles or books are published, which means that most of the researchers that you have cited are notified about your thesis, and they might read it, push it to their students, find errors, notice sloppy work and referencing, pick up interesting results and more.

¹Note that CTAN is the central place for all kinds of material around TeX, with 6649 packages as of October 2024.

²Footnotes are usually not used in mathematical texts, in particular not for citations! More on that later. In the meantime, use Oria via ub.uio.no to find books about The Millennium Prize Problems

³As a rule of thumb, try to refrain from being too creative and funny in your thesis. Write a blog, diary or send letters to a friend if you must.

Chapter 1

Results

results

1.1 Surfaces including intersecting lines

In this section we will study the problem of finding a smooth hypersurface $X_d \subset \mathbb{P}^3$ of degree d , containing k lines intersecting at a common point p and lying in a common plane H . We will denote the lines as $l_1, l_2, \dots, l_k$.

Definition 1.1.1. A k -cross is a union of k lines $l_1, l_2, \dots, l_k$ in $\mathbb{P}^3$ which intersect at a common point p . We will write $Z_k = \bigcup_{i=1}^k l_i$.

Remark 1.1.2. Note that for automorphisms of $\mathbb{P}^3$, lines are sent to lines. Therefore we can study the lines $l_0 = (\alpha : \beta : 0 : 0)$, $l_1 = (\alpha : 0 : \gamma : 0)$, $l_2 = (\alpha : \delta : \lambda_2 \delta : 0)$, $\dots$, $l_k = (\alpha : \delta : \lambda_k \delta : 0)$ for $\lambda_i \in \mathbb{N}$, take the automorphism of $\mathbb{P}^3$ which sends these lines to the given lines, and then study the hypersurface of degree d in $\mathbb{P}^3$ which contains these lines. This automorphism will also take a smooth hypersurface of degree d to a smooth hypersurface of degree d , so showing the following properties for lines in this form is sufficient for the general case.

We begin with the following lemma of non-existence:

Lemma 1.1.3. *Given k distinct lines $l_1, l_2, \dots, l_k$ in $\mathbb{P}^3$ intersecting at a common point p and lying in a common plane H , there does not exist any smooth hypersurface of degree $2 \leq d \leq k - 1$ such that the lines are contained in the hypersurface.*

Proof. Assume for contradiction that there exists a smooth hypersurface of degree $2 \leq d \leq k - 1$ such that the lines are contained in the hypersurface. Then we can fix a line l_{k+1} in H , which does not intersect p , and which does not lie in the hypersurface X_d . l_{k+1} will intersect each of the lines at a point p_i , all being distinct since the lines only intersect in p , and thus no other point. l_{k+1} will also intersect the hypersurface at the points p_i , thus intersecting the hypersurface at k points. By Bezout's theorem, the intersection of a line with a hypersurface of degree d is at most d points, giving a contradiction. $\square$

We now move on to the case of existence, with the following proposition:

Proposition 1.1.4. *For k lines in $\mathbb{P}^3$ intersecting at a common point p and lying in a common plane, we can find a smooth hypersurface of degree k such that the lines are contained in the hypersurface.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{L}$ be the linear system of hypersurfaces of degree k in $\mathbb{P}^3$ containing the lines $l_0, l_1, \dots, l_k$. Bertini's theorem states that the general member of $\mathcal{L}$ is smooth outside the

base locus of $\mathfrak{L}$. The base locus of $\mathfrak{L}$ is the union of the lines $l_0, l_1, \dots, l_k$. Thus we must find a function $f \in \mathbb{C}[x_0, x_1, x_2, x_3]_k$ such that $V(f)$ is smooth on the lines $l_0, l_1, \dots, l_k$. Bertini's theorem then gives us that we can find a hypersurface which is also smooth outside the base locus of $\mathfrak{L}$.

We study the function $f = g(x_1, x_2) + h(x_0, x_3)$, where $h = x_0^{k-1}x_3$ and $g = \prod_{i=1}^k l_i = x_1x_2 \prod_{i=3}^k (x_1 - \lambda_i x_2)$, giving the following polynomial:

$$f(x_0, x_1, x_2, x_3) = x_1x_2 \prod_{i=3}^k (x_1 - \lambda_i x_2) + x_0^{k-1}x_3$$

We can see that f is a polynomial of degree k , and that f includes the lines $l_0, l_1, \dots, l_k$, since $f(\alpha : \beta : 0 : 0) = f(\alpha : 0 : \gamma : 0) = f(\alpha : \delta : \lambda_i \delta : 0) = 0$. We must then check that f is smooth on the base locus of $\mathfrak{L}$, which is to check that $\bigcap_{i=0}^3 (\partial_i f = 0) = \emptyset$.

We get the following derivatives:

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_0 f &= \partial_0 g + \partial_0 h = 0 + (k-1)x_0^{k-2}x_3 = (k-1)x_0^{k-2}x_3 \\ \partial_1 f &= \partial_1 g + \partial_1 h = x_2 \prod_{i=3}^k (x_1 - \lambda_i x_2) + x_1x_2 \sum_{i=3}^k \prod_{\substack{j=3 \\ j \neq i}}^k (x_1 - \lambda_j x_2) \\ \partial_2 f &= \partial_2 g + \partial_2 h = x_1 \prod_{i=3}^k (x_1 - \lambda_i x_2) + x_1x_2 \sum_{i=3}^k (-\lambda_i) \cdot \prod_{\substack{j=3 \\ j \neq i}}^k (x_1 - \lambda_j x_2) \\ \partial_3 f &= \partial_3 g + \partial_3 h = 0 + x_0^{k-1} = x_0^{k-1} \end{aligned}$$

We then find that

- $\partial_0 f = 0$ on the entire base locus.
- $\partial_1 f = 0$ on the line $l_0 = (\alpha : \beta : 0 : 0)$.
- $\partial_2 f = 0$ on the line $l_1 = (\alpha : 0 : \gamma : 0)$.
- $\partial_3 f = 0$ if and only if $x_0 = 0$, which is the case for the following points: $(0 : \beta : 0 : 0), (0 : 0 : \gamma : 0), (0 : \delta : \lambda_i \delta : 0)$ for $3 \leq i \leq k$.

We can see that the intersection of all these zero locuses is empty, showing that the function f is smooth on the base locus of $\mathfrak{L}$. Thus we can find a smooth hypersurface of degree k such that the lines are contained in the hypersurface. □

By the results above, we get the following corollary:

Corollary 1.1.5. *Given k lines in $\mathbb{P}^3$ intersecting at a common point p and lying in a common plane, we can find a smooth hypersurface of degree d such that the lines are contained in the hypersurface if and only if $d \geq k$ or $d = 1$.*

Proof. If we have k lines, we can find a smooth hypersurface of degree $d \geq k + 1$ by including arbitrary lines $l_{k+1}, l_{k+2}, \dots, l_d$ lying in the plane. For the case $d = 1$, we can take the plane H containing the lines. □

1.2 The set of degree d surfaces including k-crosses

It is natural to ask about the set of degree d surfaces including k -crosses. Let Z_k be a k -cross lying in a plane H , which we will assume is the plane $\mathbb{P}_{x,y}^2$ by an automorphism of $\mathbb{P}^3$.

Proposition 1.2.1. *Let $A_k = \{S_d \subseteq \mathbb{P}^3 \mid Z_k \subset S_d\} \subseteq \{S_d \subseteq \mathbb{P}^3\}$ be the set of degree d surfaces containing Z_k . Then $\dim A_k = \binom{d+1}{2}d - k + 1$.*

Proof. $S_d = V(f)$ for some $f \in \mathbb{C}[x_0, x_1, x_2, x_3]_d$. Furthermore, since Z_k is included in the x, y plane, we write f as $f = g(x, y) + zh(x, y, z)$, separating the part of f that vanishes on the plane. Since $Z_k \subseteq S_d$, we have that $g(x, y)$ vanishes on Z_k . That $C_k \subseteq S_d$ is the same as saying that $f|_{C_k} = 0$, which is the same as saying that $g(x, y)|_{C_k} = 0$. This is because $zh(x, y, z)|_{C_k} = 0$ since $C_k \subseteq \mathbb{P}_{x,y}^2 = V(z)$. This implies that $l_1 l_2 \cdots l_k \mid g(x, y)$, meaning that $g(x, y) = l_1 l_2 \cdots l_k \cdot j(x, y)$ for some $j(x, y) \in \mathbb{C}[x, y]_{d-k}$. Thus we can write f as $f = l_1 l_2 \cdots l_k \cdot j(x, y) + zh(x, y, z)$, where $h(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{C}[x, y, z]_{d-1}$.

Finishing the argument, we get that $\dim A_k = \dim \langle j(x, y), h(x, y, z) \rangle = \binom{d-k+1}{1} + \binom{d+1}{2}$. $\square$

1.3 Surfaces including k-gons

In this section, we will consider k -gons in $\mathbb{P}^3$ and their relationship with hypersurfaces.

Definition 1.3.1. A k -gon is a union of k lines $l_1, l_2, \dots, l_k$ such that l_i intersects l_{i+1} for $1 \leq i < k$, and l_k intersects l_1 . We will write $C_k = \bigcup_{i=1}^k l_i$ and denote the intersection points as $p_i = l_i \cap l_{i+1}$ for $1 \leq i < k$, and $p_k = l_k \cap l_1$.

Proposition 1.3.2. *Let $C_k = \bigcup_{i=1}^k l_i$ be a k -gon in $\mathbb{P}^3$. Then we can find a hypersurface of degree d such that $C_k \subseteq S_d$ when $k \leq \frac{(d+3)(d+2)(d+1)}{6d}$.*

Proof. We can look at the zero cohomology of the ideal sheaf $\mathcal{I}_{C_k}$ of the k -gon to see if the k -gon can be contained in a hypersurface. We will denote the union of the lines as $C_k = \bigcup_{i=1}^k l_i$.

We have the short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{I}_{C_k} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C_k} \rightarrow 0.$$

We twist this by $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(d)$ to get

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{I}_{C_k}(d) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(d) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d) \rightarrow 0.$$

From this we get the long exact sequence in cohomology:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & H^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^0(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d)) \\ & & \searrow & & \searrow & & \searrow \\ & & H^1(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^1(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^1(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d)) \\ & & \searrow & & \searrow & & \searrow \\ & & H^2(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^2(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^2(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d)) \\ & & \searrow & & \searrow & & \searrow \\ & & H^3(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^3(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(d)) & \longrightarrow & H^3(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d)) \longrightarrow 0 \end{array}$$

We know that $H^i(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}) = 0$ for $i > 0$. This means we can focus on the first part of the sequence:

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}) \rightarrow H^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}) \rightarrow H^0(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}) \rightarrow H^1(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}) \rightarrow 0.$$

Since h^0 is additive, we get

$$h^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}) = h^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}) + h^1(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}) - h^0(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}).$$

By Thm 18.4 in (EO) we get that $h^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}) = \binom{d+3}{3}$. $h^0(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d))$ can be computed by considering the short exact sequence:

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C_k}(d) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^k \mathcal{O}_{l_i}(d) \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \mathcal{O}_{p_i} \rightarrow 0.$$

This gives us $h^0(C_k, \mathcal{O}_{C_k}) = k \cdot \binom{d+1}{1} - k = kd$.

$$h^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k}) \geq \binom{d+3}{3} - kd.$$

Meaning we can guarantee a degree d surface when $\binom{d+3}{3} - kd \geq 0$, or equivalently when $k \leq \frac{(d+3)(d+2)(d+1)}{6d}$. □

To get an exact value for $h^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k})$, we would need to compute $h^1(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k})$. This issue will be explored in section ???.

Remark 1.3.3. Note that this argument does not guarantee that the surface is smooth, only that it exists.

1.4 Computational results

We have done computational experiments in Macaulay2 to get a better understanding of the inequality above. We have tested the existence and smoothness of hypersurfaces including k -gons for various degrees d and number of lines k . The code used for these experiments is included in the following snippet. We will discuss the details of the code below, along with its results.

lst:k-gon

Listing 1.1: k-gon

```

1 -- Step 1: Define the ring and parameters
2 kk = ZZ/32749;
3 RingP3 = kk[x_0..x_3];
4 d = 2; -- Degree of the hypersurface
5 nrPoints = 4;
6
7 -- Step 2 and 3: Generate random points and create pairs of
  subsequent points
8 -- Function for generating i random points in P^3
9 randomPoints = i -> (
10   v := for j in 0..3 list random(kk);
11   -- Ensure the point is not zero
12   while all(v, x -> x == 0) do (
13     v = for j in 0..3 list random(kk)

```

```

14     );
15     v
16 )
17 -- Pick nrPoints random points in P^3
18 myPoints = apply(nrPoints, randomPoints);
19 -- Create pairs of subsequent points, and also the pair consisting
    of the last and first point
20 subsequentPairs = for i from 0 to (#myPoints - 2) list {myPoints#i
    , myPoints#(i+1)};
21 -- Add final pair
22 subsequentPairs = append(subsequentPairs, {myPoints#0, myPoints#(
    myPoints-1)});
23
24 -- Step 3: Generate matrices from point pairs
25 -- Function to convert two points to a matrix with first row {x_0
    .. x_3}
26 pointsToMatrix = points -> matrix {{x_0 .. x_3}, points#0, points
    #1};
27 -- Convert each pair of points to a matrix
28 pointsMatrix = apply(subsequentPairs, pointsToMatrix);
29
30 -- Step 4: Get the ideals of the lines
31 -- Given a matrix with first row {x_0 .. x_3} and next two rows
    points, return the ideal of the line through the points
32 lineFromPoints = pointsMatrix -> minors(3, pointsMatrix);
33 allLines = apply(pointsMatrix, lineFromPoints);
34
35 -- Step 5: Create the ideal of the union of all lines
36 -- Intersect the ideals of the lines to get ideal of the union of
    all lines
37 Iz = intersect allLines;
38
39 -- Step 6: Pick a degree d element in Iz, which defines a surface
    containing all the lines, and check properties
40 -- Pick a random degree d element in Iz
41 f = random(d, Iz);
42 -- Create the variety defined by f
43 Vf = variety ideal f;
44
45 -- Check if the surface is smooth and not the zero polynomial
46 codimension = codim singularLocus ideal f;
47 isZero = (f == 0)
48 isSingular = (codimension < 4)
49 isSmooth(Vf) and not isZero

```

We'll go through the code step by step.

Step 1: We begin by defining the field and the polynomial ring in four variables over this field. We then define the degree d of the surfaces we want to consider, and the number of points to use, which will be the same as the number of lines in the k -gon.

Step 2: We define a function to pick a given amount of random points in our quotient ring, ensuring they are not zero. We then apply the function to get the points, and gather the points into pairs of subsequent points so that we can later define lines between these.

Step 3: Next, we define a function for turning two points into a matrix. The function takes two points and returns a matrix, as follows:

$$((a, b, c, d), (d, e, f, g)) \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} x_0 & x_1 & x_2 & x_3 \\ a & b & c & d \\ d & e & f & g \end{pmatrix}$$

Step 4: Now we can define the ideal of the line between the two points by taking the 3×3 minors of this matrix.

Step 5: Next we take the intersection of all the line ideals, to get the ideal of $Z = \bigcup l_i$,

Step 6: We choose a random member of $I_Z(d)$ and compute if this defines an empty, singular, or smooth surface.

Results: We have been interested in finding the maximum number of lines k such that we can find a smooth surface of degree d including a k -gon. The results are summarized in the following table:

1.5 Cohomology of a 4-gon

As mentioned earlier, to get an exact value for $h^0(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k})$, we would need to compute $h^1(\mathbb{P}^3, \mathcal{I}_{C_k})$. We will now explore this issue for the case of a 4-gon and looking at a suitable resolution of the ideal sheaf of the 4-gon. First we claim that the intersection points of a 4-gon can, by an automorphism of $\mathbb{P}^3$, be expressed as the points $(1 : 0 : 0 : 0), (0 : 1 : 0 : 0), (0 : 0 : 1 : 0), (0 : 0 : 0 : 1)$. Then the 4-gon can be expressed as the union of the lines $l_1 = V(x_2, x_3), l_2 = V(x_0, x_3), l_3 = V(x_0, x_1), l_4 = V(x_1, x_2)$. Now the ideal of the 4-gon is given by $I_{C_4} = (x_2, x_3) \cap (x_0, x_3) \cap (x_0, x_1) \cap (x_1, x_2) = (x_1x_3, x_0x_2)$. We justify our chose of points in the following lemma.

Lemma 1.5.1. *Let C_4 be a 4-gon in $\mathbb{P}^3$. Then there exists an automorphism of $\mathbb{P}^3$ such that the intersection points of C_4 are given by the points $(1 : 0 : 0 : 0), (0 : 1 : 0 : 0), (0 : 0 : 1 : 0), (0 : 0 : 0 : 1)$.*

Proof. Let p_1, p_2, p_3, p_4 be the intersection points of C_4 . To be in general position in $\mathbb{P}^3$, we require that no three of the points are collinear, and that the points do not all lie in a plane. We can then find a projective transformation sending p_1 to $(1 : 0 : 0 : 0)$, p_2 to $(0 : 1 : 0 : 0)$, and p_3 to $(0 : 0 : 1 : 0)$. Since no three of the points are collinear, p_4 cannot be sent to a point on the line between any two of the other points. Furthermore, since the points do not all lie in a plane, p_4 cannot be sent to a point in the plane spanned by any three of the other points. Thus, we can send p_4 to $(0 : 0 : 0 : 1)$. $\square$

We will now look at a resolution of the ideal sheaf of the 4-gon. We have that $I_{C_4} = (x_1x_3, x_0x_2)$. This ideal has the following free resolution:

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(-4) \xrightarrow{\begin{pmatrix} -x_0x_2 \\ x_1x_3 \end{pmatrix}} \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^3}(-2)^{\oplus 2} \xrightarrow{\begin{pmatrix} x_1x_3 & x_0x_2 \end{pmatrix}} I_{C_4} \rightarrow 0.$$

1.6 k-chains

Definition 1.6.1. A k -chain is a union of k lines $l_1, l_2, \dots, l_k$ such that l_i intersects l_{i+1} for $1 \leq i < k$. We will write $C_k = \bigcup_{i=1}^k l_i$ and denote the intersection points as $p_i = l_i \cap l_{i+1}$ for $1 \leq i < k$.

Notice that a k-chain is a k-gon without the line l_k intersecting l_1 . One can then modify the code above to create k-chains instead of k-gons, by excluding the final pair of points. The results from this are similar to those of k-gons, in that for higher degrees, we find smooth surfaces, up until we find no surfaces. There are however interesting exceptions for degree 2 and 3. Here we get that for 4 lines and 6 lines, we get singular surfaces for 4 and 7 lines, respectively. We will handle the cases separately.

Proposition 1.6.2. *For a general 4-chain in $\mathbb{P}^3$, we cannot find a smooth quadric surface $S_2 \subset \mathbb{P}^3$ such that it includes the 4-chain.*

Proof. First, assume that S_2 is smooth. Since S_2 is a smooth quadric surface in $\mathbb{P}^3$, it is of the form $S_2 = \mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$. This means that S_2 has two rulings, meaning that there are two families of lines on S_2 , such that any two lines in the same family do not intersect, and any two lines in different families intersect at exactly one point. Denote the two families as F_1 and F_2 . Then we can see that a 4-chain must consist of two lines from F_1 and two lines from F_2 , since any two lines in the same family do not intersect. This means that the 4-chain must be of the form l_1, l_2, l_3, l_4 where $l_1, l_3 \in F_1$ and $l_2, l_4 \in F_2$. However, this means that l_4 intersects l_1 , since they are in different families, meaning that the 4-chain is in fact a 4-gon. This is a contradiction, since we assumed that we had a general 4-chain. Thus we cannot find a smooth quadric surface $S_2 \subset \mathbb{P}^3$ such that it includes the 4-chain. $\square$

Proposition 1.6.3. *For a general 4-chain in $\mathbb{P}^3$, we can find a singular quadric surface $S_2 \subset \mathbb{P}^3$ such that it includes the 4-chain.*

Proof. Find a nice example of a singular quadric surface including a 4-chain. $\square$

Now we will look at the the case of 7-chains in cubic surfaces.

Proposition 1.6.4. *For a general 7-chain in $\mathbb{P}^3$, we cannot find a smooth cubic surface $S_3 \subset \mathbb{P}^3$ such that it includes the 7-chain.*

Proof. First, the dimension of the space of cubic surfaces in $\mathbb{P}^3$ is given by the number of monomials of degree 3 in 4 variables, which is $\binom{3+4-1}{4-1} - 1 = \binom{6}{3} - 1 = 19$. Thus, the space of cubic surfaces in $\mathbb{P}^3$ has dimension 19.

Now, the linear system of 7-chains in $\mathbb{P}^3$ has dimension decided by the number of conditions imposed by the 7 lines. Recall that the set of lines in $\mathbb{P}^3$ is parametrized by the Grassmannian variety $\text{Gr}(2, 4)$, which is a 4-dimensional variety. Therefore the first line imposes 4 conditions, the second line imposes 3 conditions (since it must intersect the first line), the third line imposes 3 conditions (since it must intersect the second line), and so on. Thus, the total number of conditions imposed by the 7 lines is $4 + 3 + 3 + 3 + 3 + 3 + 3 = 22$. This being of a higher dimension than the space of cubic surfaces, we do not expect to find a cubic surface including our 7-chain. $\square$

Note that if we instead asked whether a smooth cubic surface in $\mathbb{P}^3$ can include a 7-chain, the situation is different. In this case, we can indeed find a 7-chain such that it is included in the surface. In fact, we know we could find a 12-chain in this case, and a 13-gon. We gather show this in the following proposition.

Proposition 1.6.5. *For a smooth cubic surface in $\mathbb{P}^3$, we can find a 13-gon such that it is included in the surface.*

Proof. A smooth cubic surface in $\mathbb{P}^3$ is isomorphic to the blow-up of $\mathbb{P}^2$ in 6 points. The surface then includes 27 lines, which are precisely the exceptional divisors of the blow-up, the strict transforms of the 15 lines through pairs of points, and the strict transforms of the 6 conics through 5 of the points. We can then find a 13-gon by considering the following lines: Let $E_1, E_2, E_3, E_4, E_5, E_6$ be the exceptional divisors, let L_{ij} be the strict transform of the line through points p_i and p_j , and let C_i be the strict transform of the conic through all points except p_i . Then we can consider the 13-gon given by the lines $E_1, L_{12}, E_2, L_{23}, E_3, L_{34}, E_4, L_{45}, E_5, L_{56}, E_6, C_1, L_{16}$. This is indeed a 13-gon since each line intersects exactly two other lines in the set. $\square$

By removing one of the lines from the 13-gon, we immediately get the following:

Corollary 1.6.6. *For a smooth cubic surface in $\mathbb{P}^3$, we can find a 12-chain such that it is included in the surface.*